

This month in coding

AWS announces Uniform API, Python dev wants to speed up the language, VS Code gets theming and Docker Registry opens up to IPv6

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AWS announces Uniform API Access with AWS Cloud Control API

AWS is making it easier for developers to access AWS and third-party services with the launch of the AWS Cloud Control API. It is a set of standard APIs to Create, Read, Update, Delete, and List (CRUDL) resources across hundreds of AWS Services. This way developers can



interact in a uniform fashion with hundreds of AWS services and get uniform responses in return to said queries. For example, developers could use the S3 CreateBucket API to create an Amazon S3 bucket and the EC2 RunInstances API can be used to create EC2 instances. You can literally use the APIs to create an infrastructure-as-code so using AWS becomes a lot more convenient. To start using Cloud Control API, you

Python could get faster

A suggestion for Python to drop the Global Interpreter Lock (GIL), if accepted, could end up making the language much faster than it runs currently. The GIL is a mutex which allows only one processor thread to hold the control of the Python interpreter at any given time. Essentially, Python runs on a single-thread and current gen consumer CPUs have tens of threads that programs can leverage to speed up



applications. The only reason it cannot use multiple threads is because of GIL. Python uses reference counting for memory management and anything that operates on the basis of references or pointers is susceptible to a multitude of race conditions if more than one thread is executing the code. The GIL helps prevent such race conditions from occurring and it's up to the developer to ensure that there are no conditions where a race condition

can occur. According to the suggestion, there is a tradeoff when you remove GIL but it's manageable and the speed increment achieved is worth the tradeoff. It stands to be seen if this suggestion will be accepted but if it does come to pass, then the already popular programming language would end up being even more widely used.